

Sawyer Quits, Mauch New Phillies Mgr.

PHILADELPHIA (UPI) — Eddie Sawyer, whose 1950 "Whiz Kids" were the Philadelphia Phils' only pennant-winners in the last 45 years, quit suddenly today as manager of this year's floundering Phillies and was replaced by young, aggressive Gene Mauch.

Mauch, a former major-league infielder who skippered Minneapolis into the Little World Series two straight years, announced immediately in Homestead, Fla., he hopes to become "the best big-league manager in the business."

But all that the balding 49-year-old Sawyer wants is out. The one-time college professor reached his decision to quit last night and the only explanation he would make today was, "I just don't want to manage a major-league ball club."

SECOND ERA

Mauch could not arrive here in time for tonight's game against Milwaukee, and the club was to be guided in his absence by coach Andy Cohen. Thus ended, with "surprise and shock" on the part of club officials, the Phillies' second era under Sawyer.

Most experts tab the Phils to finish last again this year, but Sawyer didn't rap the players in his resignation.

And he insisted that spring-training problems—which included a stormy incident when pitcher Jim Owens was fined \$600 for becoming involved in a taproom scrape—were not a factor in his decision. He also insisted he had no trouble with the front office.

"I just don't care to manage a major-league ball club," he repeated over and over to questioners. "I would like to stay in baseball, but have no plans at this time."